

The Game behind the Name

DivX is the brandname conferred on high-quality video compression technology. But there are different naming standards that you might come across such as DivX, DivX ;-), and OpenDivX. To a certain extent their fundamental idea is the same. They are all part of the DivX family. The difference in version is what introduces changes in the name.

DivX ;-) is version 3.11 of DivX and OpenDivX is version 4.0. The latter is not a backward compatible version, which means that it will not be able to play version 3.x rips. Formats produced by these different versions are not the same. OpenDivX would be packed with new features and it would be multi-platform.

industry to sue Scour, whose online file-sharing service is similar to the 'music bazaar' offered by Napster. While the studios fight in court over online distribution of movies, they are supporting the creation of technology that provides for secure transmission of video over the Internet.

SightSound technologies is a company that provides for video and audio download and file-sharing supporting the motion picture and music industries as they adopt digital distribution. This year, the company demonstrated the first Internet-based movie download system for distribution in theatres.

This revolutionary technology model gives people the choice of selecting between entertainment from the digital platform and other conventional means. SightSound offers short films for rent or sale on its Web site, depending on the kind of transaction that you have with the company. For rentals you could view the movie as many times as possible during the rented and allotted time slot. The Pennsylvania Company encrypts the files, and then sells electronic keys that unlock the file once for a rental or permanently for a purchase.

Final take

Because digital compression technology is improving all the time and making it possible for great quality video to be distributed easily

over the Internet, movie distribution companies are looking to use this medium to offer content to you. However, you can already see the beginning of a Napster-like situation where illegal download of movies off the Net will increase the rate of adoption of digital movie formats by consumers. This will force the hand of the distributors, as their revenues are likely to be affected. Irrespective of who comes out on top at the end, what's inescapable is that movies on your PC, and via the Internet are coming, whether or not the industry is ready for it. The only thing that is stopping anyone (consumers or movie companies) right now is the availability of the required bandwidth. Cutting-edge compression technologies and high-speed Internet access are poised to remove that last obstacle. 

<http://www.www>

www.microsoft.com/windows/windowsmedia/en/WM8/default.asp

For more information on Windows Media 8

www.realn networks.com

Learn about RealSystem iQ

www.3ivx.com

Know how DivX ;-) is used for streaming

www.sightsound.com

All about Digital Rights Management

1/2 page H. AD